Run of Show

Event: 7:00 – 9:00 PM

Times from 7:20 onward are approximate and flow from the preceding beat. G.G. paces the evening and uses the doorbell and the PA to call the house together.

ARRIVAL & GREETING — 7:00

7:00 — Arrival

Lead: The Housekeeper

Guests arrive and are greeted at the door. The character cards are laid out on a table.

> **Housekeeper:** "Welcome, we've been expecting you!"
> **Housekeeper:** "Please select your calling card." *(gestures to the table where the character cards are laid out)*

Each guest scans the QR code on their card. The Housekeeper makes sure they **tap the button and see the confirmation animation** — a scan alone does not bind them to the character.

Once confirmed, guests enter the house and read their card. The back carries their background.

Notes

- Lay out only as many cards as there are guests, arranged so each required character gets taken.
- Required: The Baker, The Heiress, The Fiduciary, The Art Collector, The Town Doctor, The Explorer.
- The Baker must be taken. If needed, assign that character before the guest is welcomed into the foyer.

ACT I — THE SETTING — 7:15

The ghosts first appear when the doors open at ≈7:30.

7:15 — G.G.'s Welcome

Lead: G.G. (The Hostess) — enters from the top of the staircase.

> **G.G.:** "Welcome, friends! Thank you for gathering here today! As you may have heard, the spirits who have been haunting the rooms of this house for a century have been restless lately. The Heiress *(may call out to the Heiress guest)* moved in and realized there is company."
> **G.G.:** "Something terrible happened in October of 1925: three young people died in the short span of 11 days, all connected to this mansion in one way or another. They have been haunting its halls ever since. Help us solve the century-old mystery and release these spirits!"
> **G.G.:** "Each of you are here for a reason, because you too are connected to this mansion whether you know it yet or not."

G.G. invites everyone to look at **the color of their card** and find the others carrying the same color.

[Optional: the Tea Server pours a glass of bubbly as the groups form.]

≈7:20 — Groups Form and Introduce *(10 min)*

Within each color group, guests introduce themselves **in character**: who they are, and what drove them here tonight.

Their **objectives** are on the front of their cards.

Note: the four card colors are the four aspects — gossip, paranormal, alchemical, adventure.

≈7:30 — The Doors Open / The Ghosts Appear

G.G. signals the Housekeeper to open the doors.

Staging

- The **Alchemist** stands in the **Library**, arms stretched toward the **Heartbroken Ghost**, who stands in the **dining room**.
- He calls out to her: *"Cordelia, forgive me!"*
- She glides slowly, eyes dreamy and detached, and does not notice him.
- The Heartbroken Ghost moves **upstairs**. The Alchemist follows.

> **G.G.:** "The spirits are especially restless tonight — they are eager for the truth."

≈7:33 — First Quest *(≈12 min)*

G.G. sends the groups out to find their first clue — an **item**.

> **G.G.:** "Work in your groups to find your first clue. It is an object, and we need it. Scan the clues to make sure you have the right one before you bring it back — and look out for 🖐 ."
> **G.G.:** "Once you have it, bring it to the piano room."

Notes

- The four objects: a Venetian glass bottle, an antique pocket watch, a wedding dress fragment belonging to the Heartbroken Ghost, and the Ginseng root the Alchemist wanders in search of.
- Guests may only touch a clue when the scan shows 🖐 .
- G.G. rings the doorbell to call everyone back to the piano room.

ACT II — THE MYSTERY EMERGES — 7:45

≈7:45 — Piano Room: What We Learned *(≈6 min)*

Everyone gathers in the piano room with the four items. G.G. asks each group in turn to report; **one representative per group** shares what they learned from their first clue.

> **G.G.:** "Thank you for gathering this important evidence."

≈7:51 — Free Investigation *(≈12 min)*

> **G.G.:** "Wander the first floor of the mansion and look for more clues. And if you see a ghost — they may be trying to tell you something important. Listen to them."

ACT III — THE INVESTIGATION — 8:03

≈8:03 — The Garden: The Lonely Ghost Appears

Lead: G.G., then The Lonely Ghost

G.G. calls everyone out to the garden.

> **G.G.** *(via PA)*: "I have an important announcement: the ghost of Alice Whitmore, the Lonely Ghost, has been spotted in the garden. She seems to have an important message for you."

Staging

- The Lonely Ghost walks slowly in from the kitchen, through the garden, to the Aviary, and stands facing the porch.
- Blue light on her pale skin and her pale ice-blue dress.
- **No fog machine, no black light** — both were cut.

> **The Lonely Ghost:** "Finally! Finally!! Someone can hear me! I have a message to share, for so long I've been silent! Cordelia, my friend. Have you seen Cordelia? I have so much to tell her."

[Optional: The Lonely Ghost catches sight of the Town Doctor and looks at them lovingly — "Thaddeus?!" — no, it can't be.]

> **The Lonely Ghost** *(distracted)*: "I have your diary, Thaddeus."

The Lonely Ghost carries **Thaddeus's diary**, which bears a QR code. She offers it out for the guests to scan.

> **G.G.:** "Scan the diary."

≈8:10 — The House Opens Up *(≈10 min investigation)*

> **G.G.:** "There are more clues scattered through the garden and the carriage house — and upstairs as well."

Staging: one of the ghosts goes upstairs and stands in the window, pointing a finger upward.

≈8:20 — Tea *(10 min)*

Lead: The Tea Server, with G.G. calling them in. G.G. never names it as a gossip break.

> **G.G.:** "Friends — come in, the tea is poured. Sit, rest your feet a moment."

> **G.G.:** "I have always found that a house gives up its secrets more easily over a warm cup. And I suspect every one of you has heard something tonight that you haven't yet said out loud."

The Tea Server works the room while pouring — warm, conspiratorial, thoroughly nosy — spreading rumors and drawing guests from *different* groups into conversation with each other.

> **Tea Server** *(leaning in with the pot)*: "Milk? Sugar? ... And what have you heard?"
> **Tea Server:** "Now, you didn't hear this from me..."
> **Tea Server:** "That's not the version I was told. You two should talk — go on, tell them what you just told me."

Note: the Tea Server keeps circulating — nobody should talk only to their own group.

ACT IV — THE REVELATION — 8:30

8:30 — The Forensic Report / The Doors Unlock

The doorbell rings. The Forensic Scientist has returned with the analysis of the elixir bottle collected earlier.

> **G.G.** *(via PA)*: "Everyone, please gather in the foyer immediately. The forensic scientist has returned with important findings."
> **Forensic Scientist:** "Thank you for gathering. I've completed my analysis of all four items you submitted. While each piece tells part of the story, the most significant finding comes from the Venetian glass bottle. The residue analysis reveals traces of *Digitalis purpurea* — foxglove. Here, read the forensic report for yourself."

Guests scan the QR code for the **Forensic Report — Elixir Bottle Analysis (DM133)**.

[If the Forensic Scientist is not cast, G.G. delivers the findings herself.]

At the same time: the Housekeeper unlocks the kitchen and Neil's bedroom, which have been locked all evening. G.G. announces it.

> **G.G.:** "Two doors in this house have been locked all evening. They are open now — the kitchen, and the bedroom at the top of the stairs."

≈8:32 — The Last Clues and the Treasure *(≈10 min)*

Guests move into the newly opened rooms for the final clues, then out to the garden for the treasure.

Notes

- The treasure is buried **next to the rose planter**. The map is hidden in the purple and gold vase, and the lock code is **DRAKE** — Colonel Charles Drake, the name attached to the aviary.
- The chest holds chocolate coins.

ACT V — CONCLUSIONS — 8:42

≈8:42 — Living Room: The Questions

G.G. calls everyone into the living room and puts one question to each group in turn.

> **G.G.:** "Before we reveal the complete truth, let us test your investigation."

Gossip — Secret Baby

> *"Whose child was given away, and what does that mean for this estate?"*
> Eleanor Sullivan was the secret daughter of Cordelia Montrose and Thomas Whitmore. The Montrose family forced Cordelia to give the baby away to the Sullivans. The adoption was never finalized — Eleanor is the true heir to the Montrose estate.

Alchemical — Sebastian's Elixir

> *"What was truly in the Alchemist's formula?"*
> The Elixir of Eternal Love was a harmless romantic potion. His brother, Dr. Thaddeus Crane, secretly added concentrated foxglove, turning it into a slow-acting poison. Sebastian died testing his own creation, never knowing his brother had corrupted it. Cordelia died of six weeks of accumulated poisoning.

Paranormal — Alice Whitmore

> *"Who silenced the Lonely Ghost, and why?"*

> Alice was a genuine psychic who fell in love with her doctor, Thaddeus Crane. When Cordelia discovered the affair and threatened to expose him, he poisoned Sebastian's elixir to silence her. Alice learned the truth and demanded he confess. He murdered her with a silver candle holder on the staircase and staged it as a fall.

Adventure — Dirty Dealings

> *"What was hidden on these grounds, and who hid it?"*
> The Romano treasure is real, hidden across the estate by Frankie Romano, who used Sebastian's apothecary as a front for smuggling during Prohibition. He left a coded trail — One, Two, Three — from the Methuselah Palm to the paintings to the purple vase to the aviary.

≈8:52 — Conclusions / The Heir

> **G.G.:** "Thank you, investigators. You have uncovered the truth that has been hidden for a century. Dr. Thaddeus Crane's terrible secret has finally been revealed."

G.G. names **The Baker** as the heir to the Montrose estate — Eleanor's descendant, carrying her rose bread recipe and her bloodline.

≈8:55 — The Staircase: The Release

G.G. moves to the staircase. The ghosts have already gathered at the top.

She asks everyone to repeat after her. G.G. speaks each line; the room repeats it back before she moves to the next.

> The glass remembers Confessions bound Walk to the sea In truth, be free

The ghosts are released. They walk out the front door.

9:00 — Evening concludes.